Attachment 12

# Data Protection Impact Assessment

To Renounce Liberty? A Public-Goods Experiment on (Un)Democratic Reversal

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**Status of this assessment**

This project-specific DPIA documents the planned processing and safeguards using the University of Turku structure. It covers the research team's oTree data and separate payment records; UTU RPP/TOKA does not receive research data, payment information, or oTree codes. UTU Choice Lab does not prepare a separate project DPIA because, as confirmed by its Lab Manager, the laboratory does not process this project's research or payment data. It will be reviewed after technical pilots, before production, and whenever the platform, collected variables, access arrangements, or risk profile changes materially.

## 1. Project and contact

**Project:** To Renounce Liberty? A Public-Goods Experiment on (Un)Democratic Reversal.
**Principal Investigator and contact for personal-data matters:** Janne Tukiainen, Professor, Turku School of Economics, University of Turku;
janne.tukiainen@utu.fi.
**Controller/DPO:** University of Turku; dpo@utu.fi; +358 29 450 3009.
**UTU Choice Lab confirmation:** Satu Metsälampi, Lab Manager; satu.metsalampi@utu.fi; toka@utu.fi.

## 2. Nature, scope, and context of processing

The target is 300 adults who complete one laboratory session lasting approximately 60 minutes, with data collection planned for 1–31 October 2026 at UTU Choice Lab ~~and, if needed to accelerate recruitment, Tampere DMLab~~. Participants remain in matching pools of ~~10 or 15~~ 5, 10, or 15 ~~and are reshuffled into five-person groups~~. Larger pools are reshuffled into five-person groups, while a five-person pool plays together throughout. oTree records coded behavioral decisions across ~~twenty~~ fifteen rounds (ten before assignment and five afterward), laboratory site, pool-wide recovery or persistence assignment, group and pool identifiers, response times, payoffs, expectations, comprehension items, a study-specific consent record, eleven process questions, and twelve optional background questions. The background module records age group, gender, education, household financial strain, 2023 parliamentary vote, left–right placement, democratic support and satisfaction, strong-leader views, political efficacy, generalized trust, and risk willingness. Party vote and political-attitude responses are special-category personal data. No direct identifiers, audio, video, biometric data, health data, criminal records, or free text are collected in the interface.

At the end of the first ten-person session, a separate six-question feedback form offers three clarity ratings and three optional text fields of up to 600 characters. It stores only aggregate rating counts and independent shuffled text lists. It creates no linked individual questionnaire or record of participant code, session, timestamp, IP address, or response order. The invitation appears after all main questionnaires and before the debrief and payment display; participation is optional and payment-independent. Participants are instructed not to enter identifying details. The researcher disables the invitation after this pretest session.

~~Each host laboratory separately administers recruitment, attendance, and payment through its participant system: UTU Choice Lab uses UTU RPP/TOKA and DMLab uses ORSEE. A host laboratory may temporarily link an identity to a participant code. Researchers receive only coded~~

~~experimental data and never receive the link; the host laboratory removes it after payment under its procedure. When DMLab is used, Tampere University independently controls its separate ORSEE administrative records.~~ UTU Choice Lab administers recruitment and attendance through UTU RPP/TOKA. UTU RPP/TOKA does not assign oTree codes, receive experimental responses, administer payment, or link an identity to a research record. oTree generates the study code. The research team administers immediate payment using a separate code-and-amount list; any named receipt does not contain an oTree code. The research team stores, validates, analyses, aggregates, reports, retains coded data for compatible future research, archives anonymous outputs, and deletes data when no longer necessary. No oTree artificial-intelligence functions are enabled, and no participant or research data are sent to an artificial-intelligence system. Any AI-assisted language proofreading is limited to nonconfidential study materials before data collection. The experimental randomization affects only the fictional task and payment opportunities within the session; it creates no legal or similarly significant external decision.

## 3. Purpose, necessity, and proportionality

The specified purpose is scientific research on consequential institutional choice and group approval. Individual-level longitudinal decisions are necessary to observe whether the same participant changes an institutional ballot; pool and group identifiers are necessary for randomization, rematching, payoff calculation, and valid statistical uncertainty. Response times identify delays and implementation problems. Expectations and final questions check comprehension and help interpret behavioral patterns.

The design minimises data by omitting names from the interface, avoiding free text in coded experimental records, making all background questions optional, collecting them only after paid decisions, and limiting them to prespecified demographic, economic, political, democratic-attitude, trust, and risk constructs stated in the research plan. The research cannot answer its within-person question using anonymous aggregate counts collected only once. ~~Coded individual records are therefore necessary, while the host laboratory's separate link, if used, permits payment and is removed afterward.~~ Coded individual records are therefore necessary during the session. Immediate payment uses a separate code-and-amount list, which is deleted after reconciliation without creating an identity-to-code link in the research dataset. Laboratory-site, matching-pool, and pool-size fields are necessary to document collection, assignment, and statistical uncertainty.

The lawful bases are scientific research in the public interest under GDPR Article 6(1)(e), Article 9(2)(j), Article 89, and sections 4(3) and 6(1)(7) of the Finnish Data Protection Act. Payment information collected by the research team is processed under GDPR Article 6(1)(b); any required reporting to the Finnish Tax Administration is under Article 6(1)(c). Registration through ~~the host laboratory's participant system~~ UTU RPP/TOKA records acceptance of its general rules and privacy information. Before experimental decisions, oTree supplies project-specific information and records a concise ethical consent; this consent is not the GDPR processing basis. No data-subject right is categorically excluded in advance; requests are evaluated case by case. Data portability does not apply to a public-interest task, and Article 11 may apply ~~after the linkage key is removed~~ when the research record cannot be identified, including from information supplied by the participant.

## 4. Systems, people, and data flow

1. ~~The host laboratory recruits and schedules adults through UTU RPP/TOKA or ORSEE and assigns the code used for the laboratory session.~~ UTU Choice Lab recruits and schedules adults through UTU RPP/TOKA, which records registration and attendance separately from the study. oTree generates the code used in the laboratory session.
2. At the laboratory, ~~the code~~ oTree opens ~~oTree~~ the study. Study-specific consent, its form version, timestamp, and laboratory site are recorded electronically. ~~The host laboratory keeps any identity-to-code link separate.~~ No identity-to-code link is created.
3. oTree stores coded responses, treatment, interaction identifiers, response times, and payoffs on a

University of Turku IT server with an `utu.fi` domain in Finland~~, including for DMLab sessions~~.

4. Janne Tukiainen, Hector Bahamonde, and authorised personnel access coded data on University IT-provided storage. The raw export becomes read-only; scripted processing creates analysis data.
5. ~~The host laboratory administers payment separately and removes any identity-to-code link once compensation has been paid under its procedure.~~ The research team administers immediate payment using a temporary oTree code-and-amount list. Any named payment receipt has no oTree code; the temporary list is destroyed after payment reconciliation.
6. Results are reported in aggregate. Anonymisation requires removal or coarsening of identifying combinations and a documented disclosure-risk review. Until anonymisation is confirmed, coded data remain restricted personal data. Only disclosure-checked anonymous data and code may be shared publicly.

Live data are hosted and backed up on University of Turku IT-provided servers in Finland. The public prototype is not used for live data. No transfer outside Finland or the EU/EEA is planned.

## 5. Rights and organisational safeguards

Participants receive clear advance information, can decline or stop, and have a study contact and DPO contact. Before paid play, ~~laboratory staff~~ the researcher or trained research assistant finalise a consenting roster of ~~10, 15, or 20~~ 5, 10, 15, or 20 and form fixed matching pools of ~~10 or 15~~ 5, 10, or 15; surplus arrivals and anyone who declines are handled under the ~~host laboratory's~~ study's procedures and never rotate into an active pool. Individual ballots are not displayed to other participants. ~~Laboratory staff~~ The researcher or trained research assistant see only information needed to operate the synchronized session and payment. Researchers and staff receive confidentiality and incident-handling instructions appropriate to their roles.

Technical safeguards include participant codes, ~~the host laboratory's separate and temporary linkage data~~ a separate temporary code-and-amount payment list with no identity-to-code linkage, access control, institutional credentials, encrypted connections, two-factor authentication where available, managed backups, versioned code, audit/session logs, and secure deletion. Exports are limited to University-managed devices and UTU IT-provided storage. Small-cell outputs and combinations of site, session, pool, treatment, response, or payoff variables are assessed before release.

The pretest form is served through a common address without oTree identifiers, browser-session tracking, or referrer information. Application and production-proxy request/response logging for that address are disabled and verified before use. Feedback aggregates are held separately on University IT storage with researcher-only access; public access does not expose the stored answers. Text is reviewed for volunteered identifying details before use or sharing.

## 6. Risk assessment and controls

| Risk to participant | Initial assessment | Controls and residual assessment |
|---|---|---|
| Unauthorised disclosure of questionnaire answers or decisions | Moderate impact; low-to-moderate likelihood | Codes rather than names, special-category handling, restricted access, encryption, no raw email transfer, aggregate reporting. Residual: low. |

| Risk to participant | Initial assessment | Controls and residual assessment |
|---|---|---|
| Linkage of experimental choices to recruitment or payment identity | Moderate impact; low likelihood | ~~The host laboratory alone holds any separate link; researchers receive only coded data; the laboratory removes the link after payment.~~ UTU RPP/TOKA does not receive oTree codes or research data. The research team keeps named receipts separate from the temporary code-and-amount list, which is destroyed after reconciliation. Residual: low. |
| Re-identification from pool, session, payoff, or rare response combinations | Moderate impact; low-to-moderate likelihood | No public session dates or operational labels, small-cell review, coarsening/suppression, anonymous release only. Residual: low. |
| Disclosure to other participants during interaction | Low-to-moderate impact; low likelihood | Private institutional and approval ballots, ~~anonymous rematching~~ unlabelled interaction, with rematching in larger pools, group totals only, no persistent on-screen identities. Residual: low. |
| Identification through pretest feedback | Low-to-moderate impact; low likelihood | Separate common address, no linked records or request logs, aggregate ratings and shuffled text lists, identifying-detail warning and text review. Residual: low. |
| Loss, alteration, or corruption of research data | Low-to-moderate impact; low likelihood | Read-only raw export, scripted cleaning, version control, checksums where practical, managed backups, access logs. Residual: low. |
| External platform access or non-EEA transfer | Moderate-to-high impact; low likelihood | Production oTree and storage on University IT servers in Finland; no live data on the public prototype; no non-EEA transfer. Residual: low. |
| Use of an individual choice to stigmatise or classify a participant | Moderate impact; low likelihood | No individual reporting, no consequential automated profiling, neutral instructions, debrief stating that no vote or transfer defines a person's political or moral character. Residual: low. |

## 7. Residual risk, consultation, and review

After the stated measures, residual risk is expected to be low and proportionate to the scientific purpose. No unmitigated high risk has been identified. If ~~a host laboratory~~ the collection site, collected variables, access arrangements, future use, or data-subject-rights approach changes materially, or if a breach exposes ~~a host laboratory's linkage~~ a temporary payment record, data collection will pause and the relevant controller/DPO will reassess the design and any need for prior consultation with the Data Protection Ombudsman.

The DPIA will be reviewed after technical pilots, immediately before production, after any material platform or data change, and if an incident changes the risk profile. Any advice from the DPO, ethics committee, ~~host laboratories~~ UTU Choice Lab, or data services will be recorded with the final version.

| Responsible researcher | Data Protection Officer review |
|---|---|
| Name: Janne Tukiainen | Name: _____ |
| Date/signature: _____ | Date/signature: _____ |

**Guidance used.** UTU DPIA template; GDPR Articles 6, 9, 11, 35, and 89; Finnish Data Protection Act 1050/2018, sections 4, 6, and 31.